

A Very Bad Day

Greta made the meanest salsa in the county. Her biscuits weren't too bad either. On Tuesday, Bernardo of Tex-Mex Emporium called Greta to order a vat of salsa and a few dozen biscuits, as was his custom every week or so. He told her he'd send a messenger named Laurie to pick everything up tomorrow. Greta got to work, mixing a large bowl of batter and put it in the oven. Just as she turned it on, she heard a thump from upstairs. She found her husband lying unresponsive on the floor. An ambulance, a night at the hospital... he didn't make it. Wednesday morning, Laurie knocked at the open front door, and when no one answered, walked in to find Greta seated at the kitchen table in yesterday's dress, staring blankly at her life. Laurie didn't know what to say. "I'm Laurie for your sauce", she said softly. Greta threw her head into her arms on the table and started sobbing. What did she say wrong? Laurie looked around the kitchen hoping to find some clue and noticed the charred remains of what could have been biscuits in a blackened oven. Maybe Greta had been frightened by an explosion? An oven fire? Laurie suggested, slowly, "A noise, in a batter blaze." Greta lifted her head, and the sobs turned into wailing.

